



Let's go through the process of installing and running a WordPress-based site on a Windows server.

WordPress is open source content management software that is very widely used across the world to create websites and blogs. One of the major advantages of WordPress is its plug and play architecture. Its versatility and millions of plugins allows you to customise your sites and gives you a competitive edge. Currently, there are many e-commerce and private social network sites that use WordPress.

WordPress can either be used online at www.wordpress.com or accessed as a downloadable version at www.wordpress.org.

Though it is open source software, it can be hosted either on an open source-based platform or on a Windows-based Web platform, in order to build custom sites. Microsoft provides a robust Web platform and a set of comprehensive tools which can be used to host WordPress. Microsoft's Web platform interface for hosting WordPress is the key focus of this article.

An introduction to Web Server Roles or IIS

The Microsoft Windows Server family provides numerous server roles that can handle complex IT tasks. One of the main roles used in configuring and managing Web-based applications is the Web Server Role or Internet Information Services (IIS). Windows' Web Server Role lets you share information with users on the Internet, an intranet, or extranet, using sites, pages, etc. Using this, you can deploy and manage websites and applications across large farms of Web servers from a central place. One of the major advantages of using IIS is its scalability and open architecture.

Windows Server 2008 and Windows Server 2008 R2 deliver IIS 7, which is a unified Web platform that integrates IIS, ASP, NET, Windows Communication Foundation and Windows SharePoint Services. Microsoft introduced IIS 8.5 with Windows Server 2012 R2, which has helped it improve support for organisations that have a large number of websites to manage.

Prerequisites for hosting WordPress on a Windows-based system

Before you install WordPress with Microsoft Web Platform, ensure that the following prerequisites are in place on your Windows system.

WordPress prerequisites: <http://wordpress.org/about/requirements/>

IIS prerequisites: <http://msdn.microsoft.com/en-us/library/cc268240.aspx>

Installing WordPress on a Windows-based system

Microsoft WebMatrix and Microsoft Web Platform Installer (Web PI) are two very effective tools from Microsoft that automate the installation of WordPress. With these tools, you have the option to install not only Microsoft-based Web components but also a huge set of open source applications and built-in templates. Both these tools can be used to successfully install and host WordPress on a Windows-based system in order to create, publish and maintain your websites. These tools install the latest components of the Microsoft Web Platform including Internet Information Services (IIS), SQL Server Express, .NET Framework and Visual Web Developer.

To host a site from a Windows-based system using WordPress, you will need to install one of the following tools and use it to download and install WordPress and all the other required applications. Given below are the basic guidelines for installing WordPress using these tools. Ensure that your system is connected to the Internet before starting the process. You can also download all the required components offline and install WordPress. Using an online method with these tools is recommended, as it always fetches the data dynamically and allows you to install the latest supported components.